



Understanding the Modern **Saudi** Fashion Consumer

A consumer study by Chalhoub Group





Why Focus on **Fashion** in **Saudi Arabia?**

TRANSFORMING UNDER VISION 2030

**Vibrant
economy**

**Burgeoning
fashion industry**

**Growth engine
for the Group**



About the Study

Phase 1: Qualitative

17 in-depth online interviews | Dec 2020

Saudis only | 18 to 35 years

Females only

**Buy fashion on a
regular basis**

8 cities

**Primary
cities**

**Jeddah
Riyadh**

**Secondary
cities**

**Mecca
Madinah
Khobar**

**Remote
cities**

**Jubail
Najran
Yanbu**

Phase 2: Quantitative

1,605 online* interviews | Feb 2021

Saudis only | 18 to 35 years

Female majority (65%)

**Clothes SAR 500
Every 3 months**

**Shoes SAR 500
Every 6 months**

10 cities

**Primary
cities**

**Jeddah (15%)
Riyadh (15%)**

**Secondary
cities**

**Mecca (15%)
Dammam (13%)
Madinah (10%)
Khobar (7%)**

**Remote
cities**

**Tabuk (8%)
Qassim (8%)
Abha (6%)
Khamis Mushet
(5%)**



Cluster Highlights

Primary cities

Leading the curve



Secondary cities

Embracing change



Remote cities

Keeping with traditions





Primary cities

Leading the curve

Fashion to **stand out**

Visible brands and **latest trends**

Interest in **sustainable** and **niche** brands

Online shopping for **convenience**

Travel **abroad**

Shop across a range from fast fashion to high end luxury



Secondary cities

Embracing change

Fashion for **status**

Visible brands

Interest in **sustainable** and **niche** brands

Online shopping for **variety**

Travel **abroad**

Shop across a range from fast fashion to high end luxury



Remote cities

Keeping with traditions

Fashion to **fit in**

Unique pieces (typically tailored)

Interest in **local brands** (but not as we know it- e.g. tailored/ local shops)

Online shopping... **bc they have to**

Travel **within** KSA

More focused on **fast fashion**



What **Role** Does **Fashion** Play in **Saudis'** Lives?

Fashion is... a key area of spending

**AFFLUENT
WOMEN**

SECONDARY CITIES

REMOTE CITIES



79%

*ranked retail shopping in their
top 3 areas of discretionary spending*

vs.

48%

for dining out

41%

for electronics

When it comes to your disposable income, please rank your top three areas of expenditure (excluding rent, utilities and groceries) during a regular year?

Fashion is... first and foremost a means of expression

PRIMARY CITIES



70% *“A way of expressing my personality and style”*

60% *“A way of rewarding myself”*

56% *“A way of standing out from the crowd”*

Secondary cities

50%

“A way of showing my social status”

vs 45%
in primary cities

Remote cities

38%

“A way of connecting with my peers”

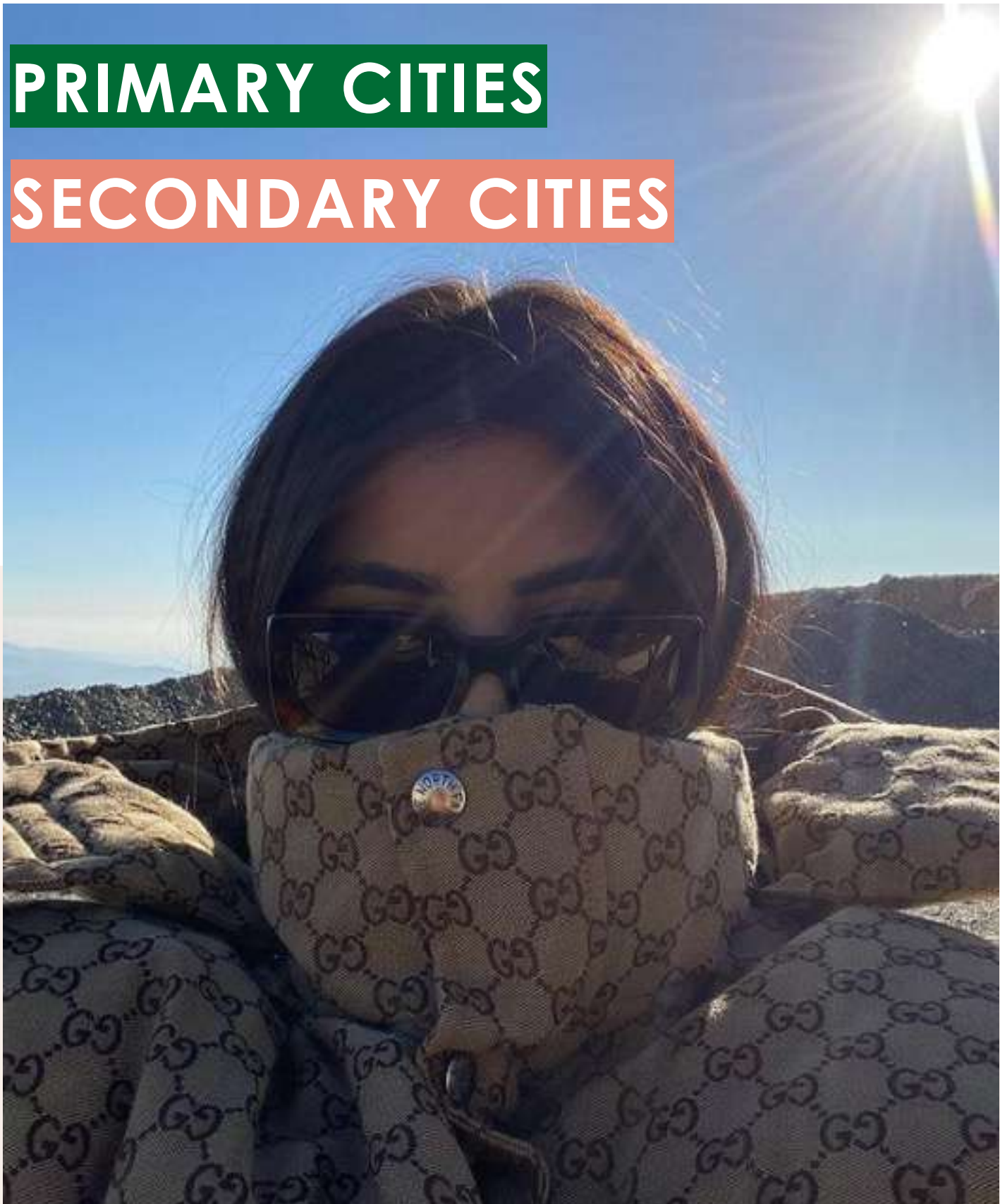
vs 30%
in primary cities

When it comes to your relationship with fashion, which of the below statements do you relate to the most? Please rank up to three statements that best describe this % are those who ranked within their top 3 choices

Fashion is... about comfort and recognition

PRIMARY CITIES

SECONDARY CITIES



61% *Wear pieces from recognizable brands*

60% *Wear comfortable and practical pieces*

53% *Wear the latest fashion trends*

REMOTE CITIES: LESS TREND DRIVEN

50%

*Wear pieces from
recognisable brands*

vs 65%
in primary cities

45%

*Wear the latest
fashion trends*

vs 57%
in primary cities

54%

*Wear unique pieces
no-one else will have*

vs 49%
in primary cities

When it comes to your fashion style, which of the below statements best describe your style?
Please rank up to three of the statements that best describe this. % are those who ranked
within their top 3 choices

Primary cities pushing demand for athleisure



85%* in **primary cities** plan on buying sneakers in the coming 12 months
vs 48% in remote cities

**Among those who plan on buying shoes/clothes in the coming 12 months*

53%* plan on buying activewear in the coming 12 months
vs 38% in remote cities



You mentioned you're likely to buy clothes /shoes in the next 12 months.
What kind of clothes/shoes are you most likely to buy?

While **remote cities** push traditional clothing and footwear

45% in **remote cities** plan on buying traditional clothing in the coming 12 months
vs 22% in primary cities

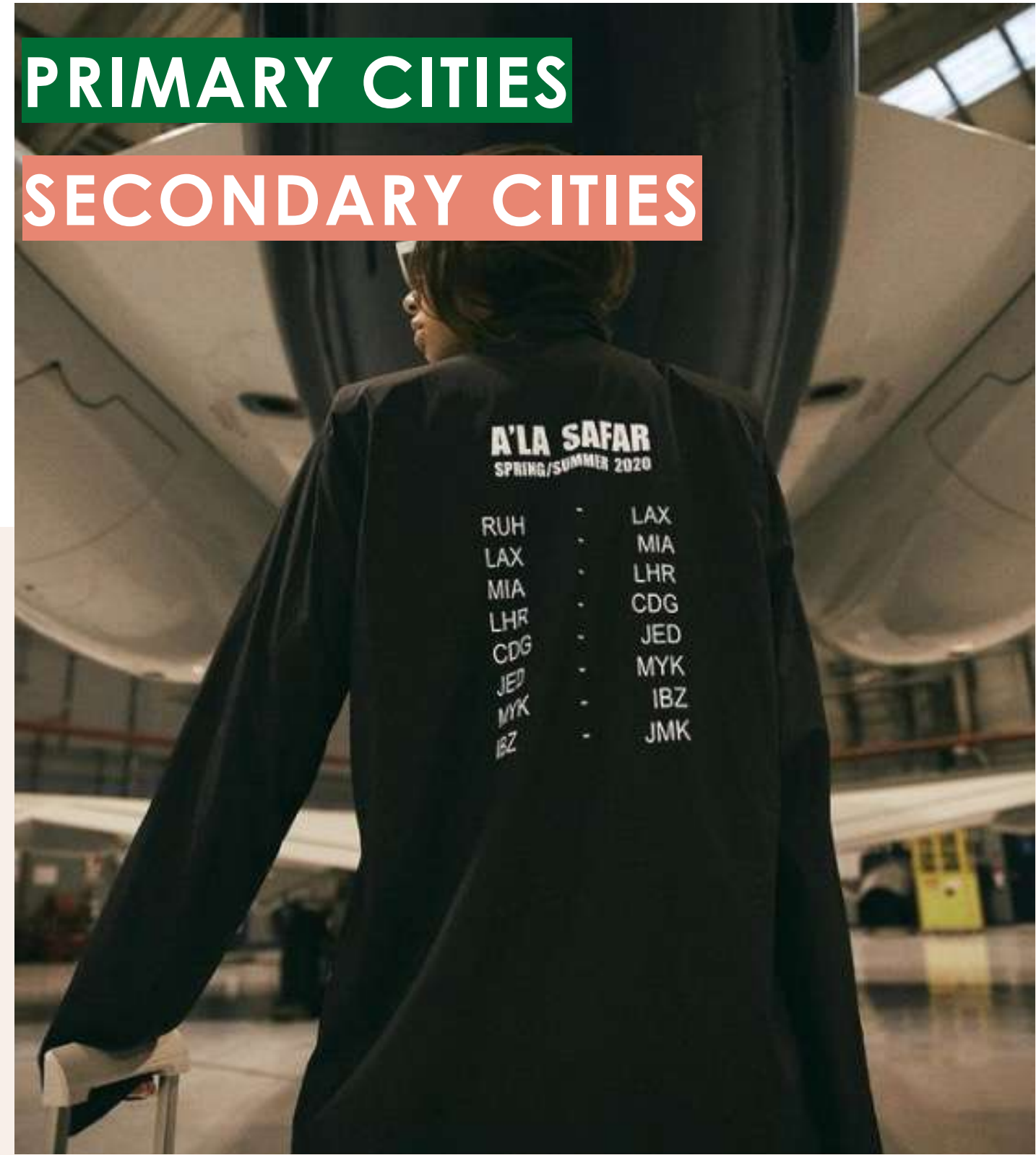


64%* plan on buying sandals in the coming 12 months
vs 42% in primary cities

**Among those who plan on buying shoes in the coming 12 months*

In the next 12 months, which of the below categories are you most likely to buy?
Please rank up to three categories

Fashion is... still mostly about mainstream brands but primary and secondary cities pushing beyond this



69% *Buy from well-known, international brands*

58% *Buy from niche brands*

52% *Buy from sustainable brands*

REMOTE CITIES: *LOCAL DESIGNERS BUT NOT QUITE AS WE KNOW IT*

61%
**Buy from local/regional
brands and designers**
vs 45%
in primary cities

“ *From the interviews*

“I find designs from brands I like on Instagram, and have a local tailor design something similar”

”

When it comes to your purchase behaviour, which of the below statements best describe your behaviour? Please rank up to three of the statements that best describe this. % are those who ranked within their top 3 choices



Mapping the Consumer Journey

Fashion inspiration typically starts online...

less so in *remote cities*



42% Instagram

29% Browsing online

29% YouTube

28% Browsing the mall **REMOTE CITIES**

25% Family & friends **REMOTE CITIES**

Where do you get your fashion inspiration from? Please select up to three answers

A lower proportion of Saudis in **remote cities** buy above fast fashion

~44% <SAR 30,000

~29%

of Saudis in **remote cities**
don't buy premium, affordable luxury
or high end luxury fashion

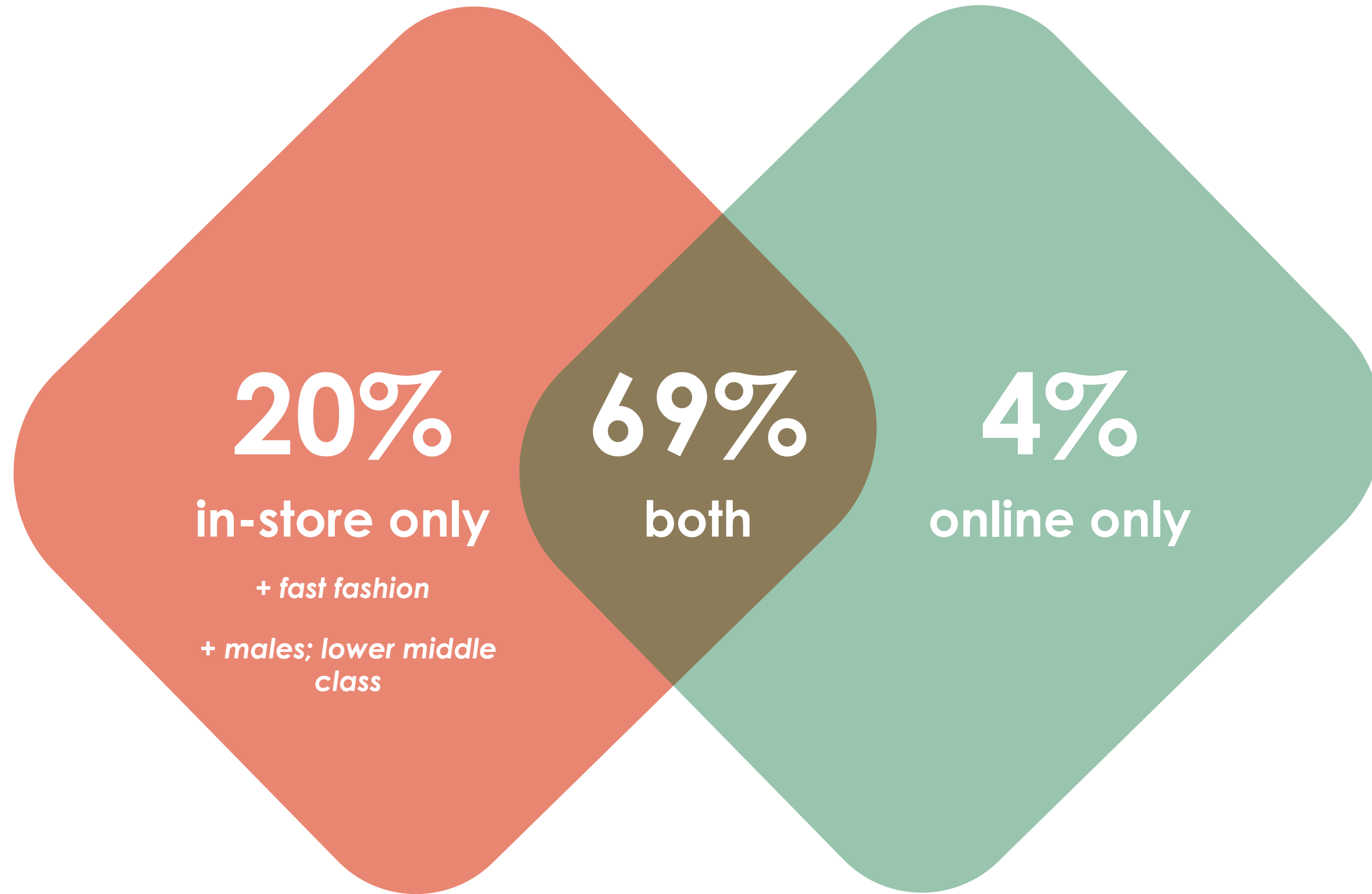
VS

~3%

of Saudis in **primary** or **secondary** cities
don't buy premium, affordable luxury
or high end luxury fashion

When shopping for fashion brands, do you usually shop in-store or online? (Those who answered "I do not buy this category")

Saudis are omnichannel shoppers... but more fast fashion is bought in-store



When shopping for fashion brands, do you usually shop in-store or online?

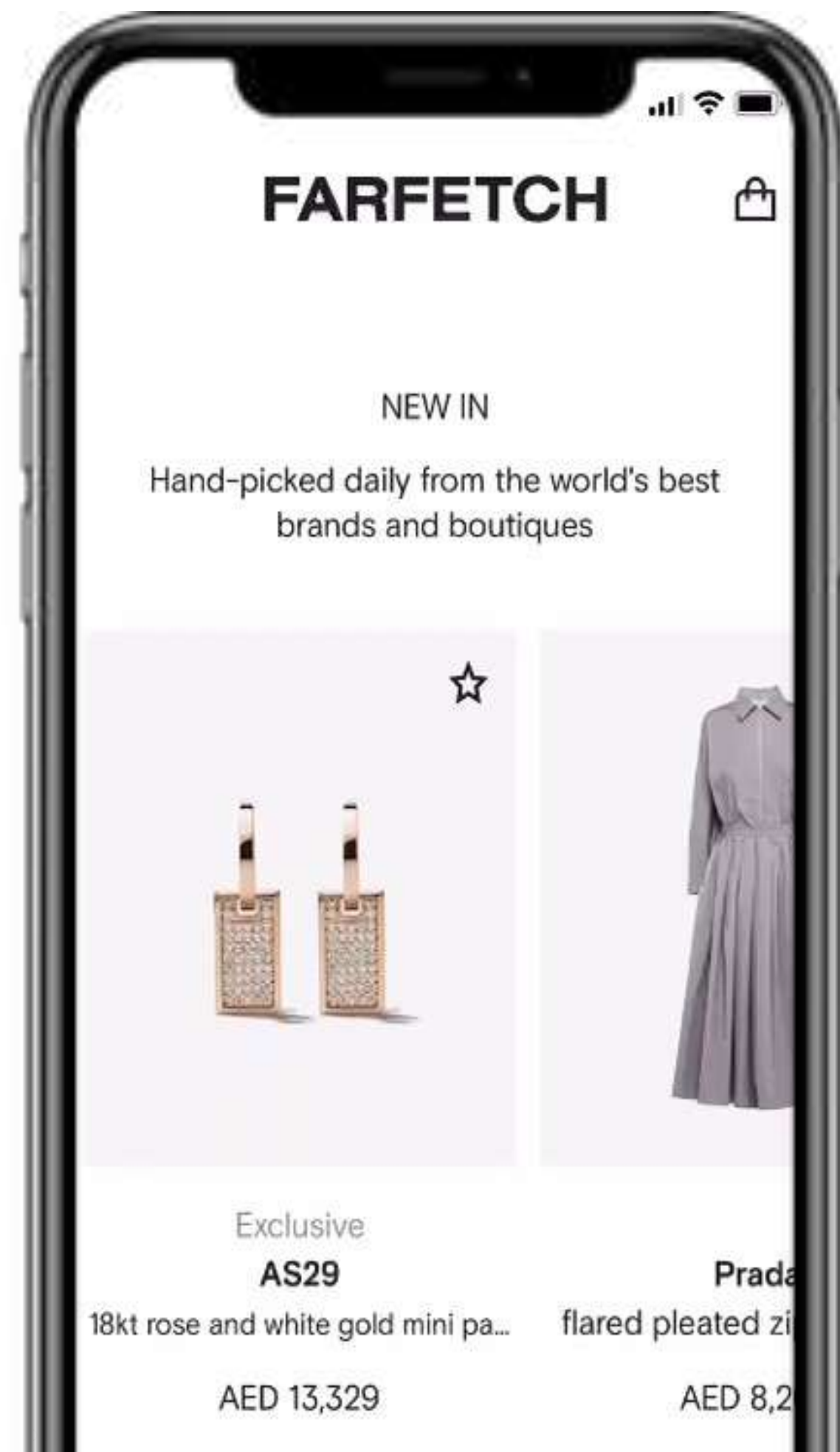
Whether online or in-store, Saudis tend to shop most often from the brand itself

In-store

- #1 Brand store
- #2 Department store
- #3 Concept store
- #4 Seasonal pop-up
- #5 Outlet store

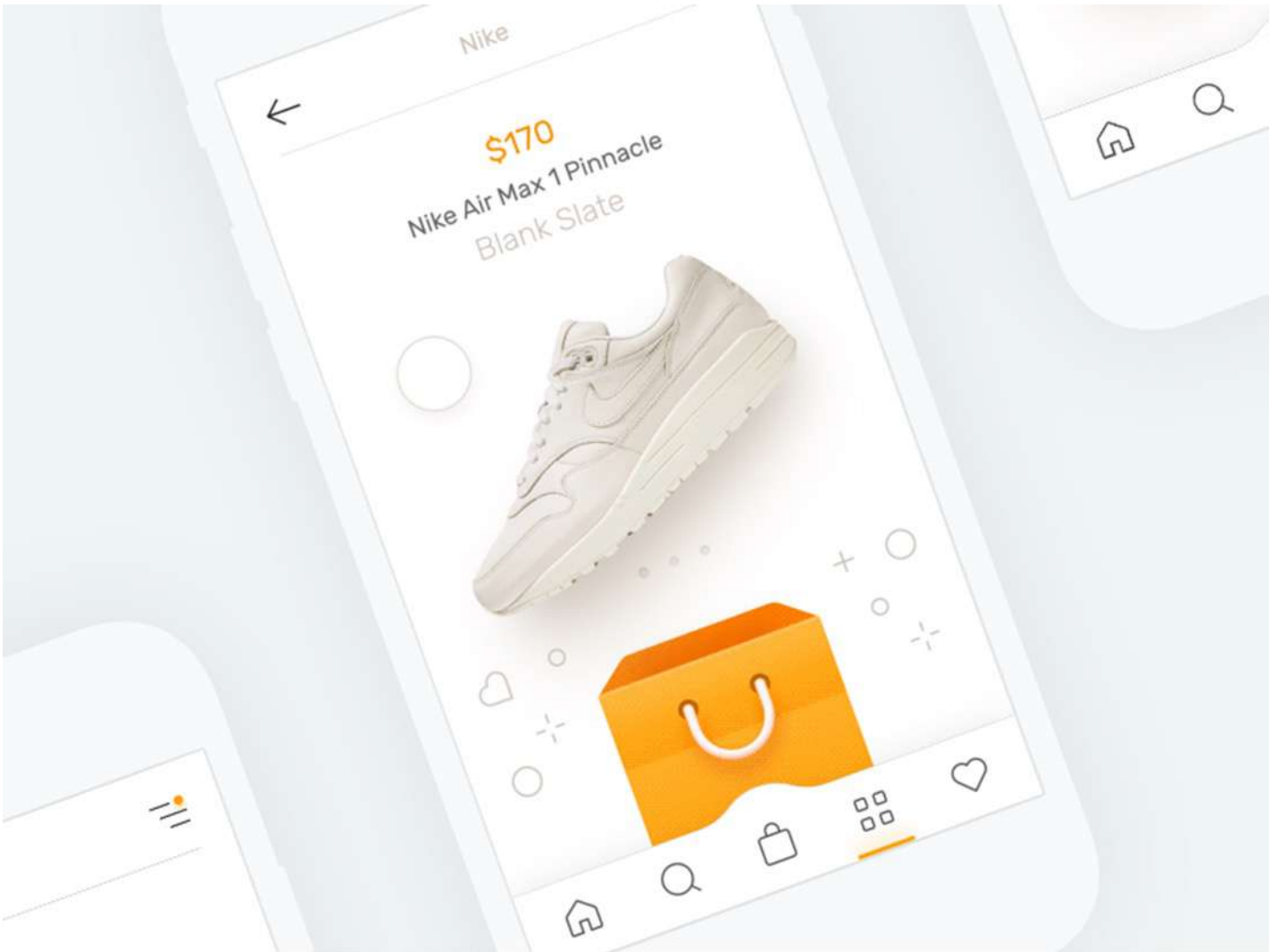
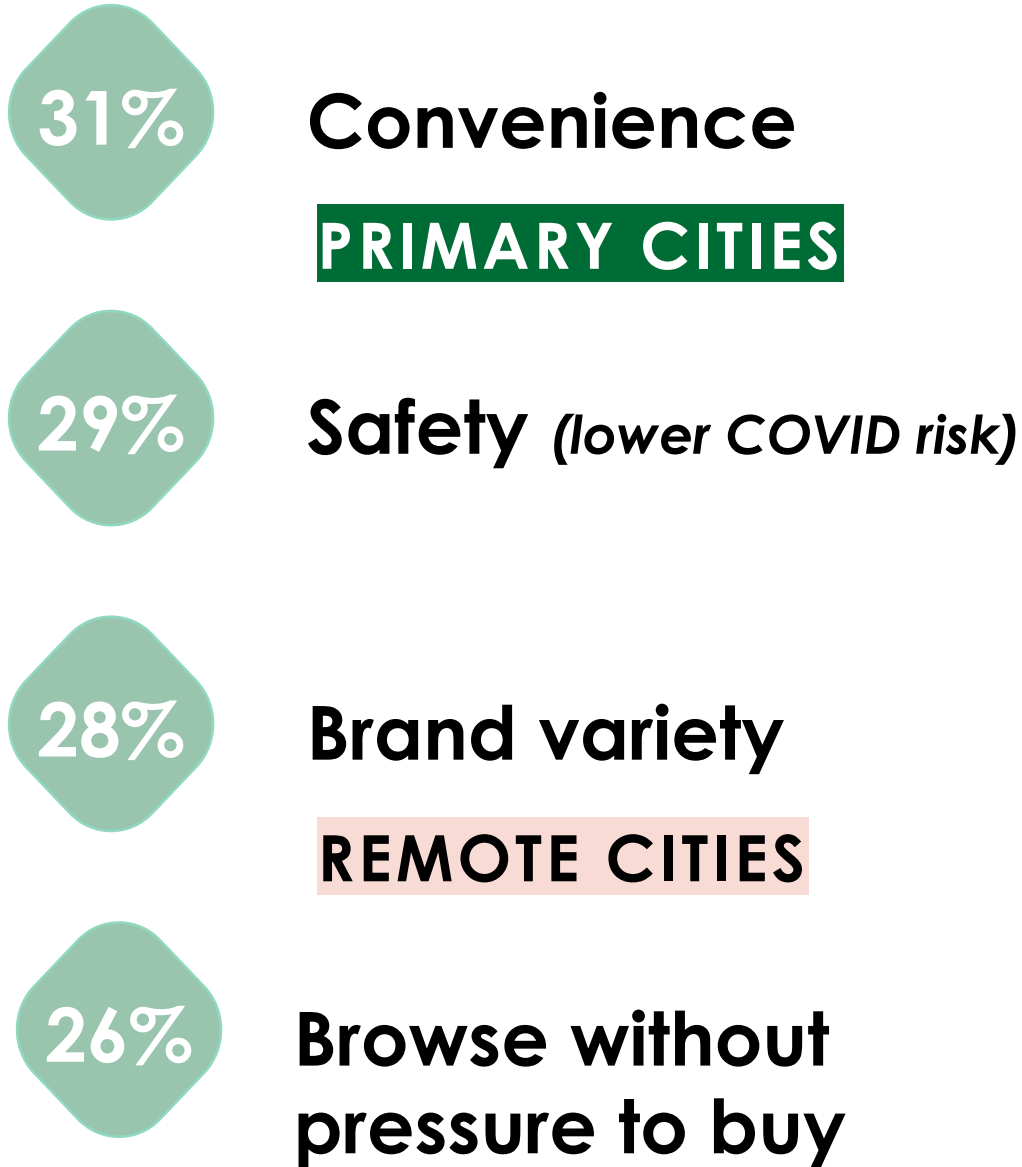
Online

- #1 Brand website
- #2 Marketplace
- #3 Multi-brand website
- #4 Department website
- #5 Concept website



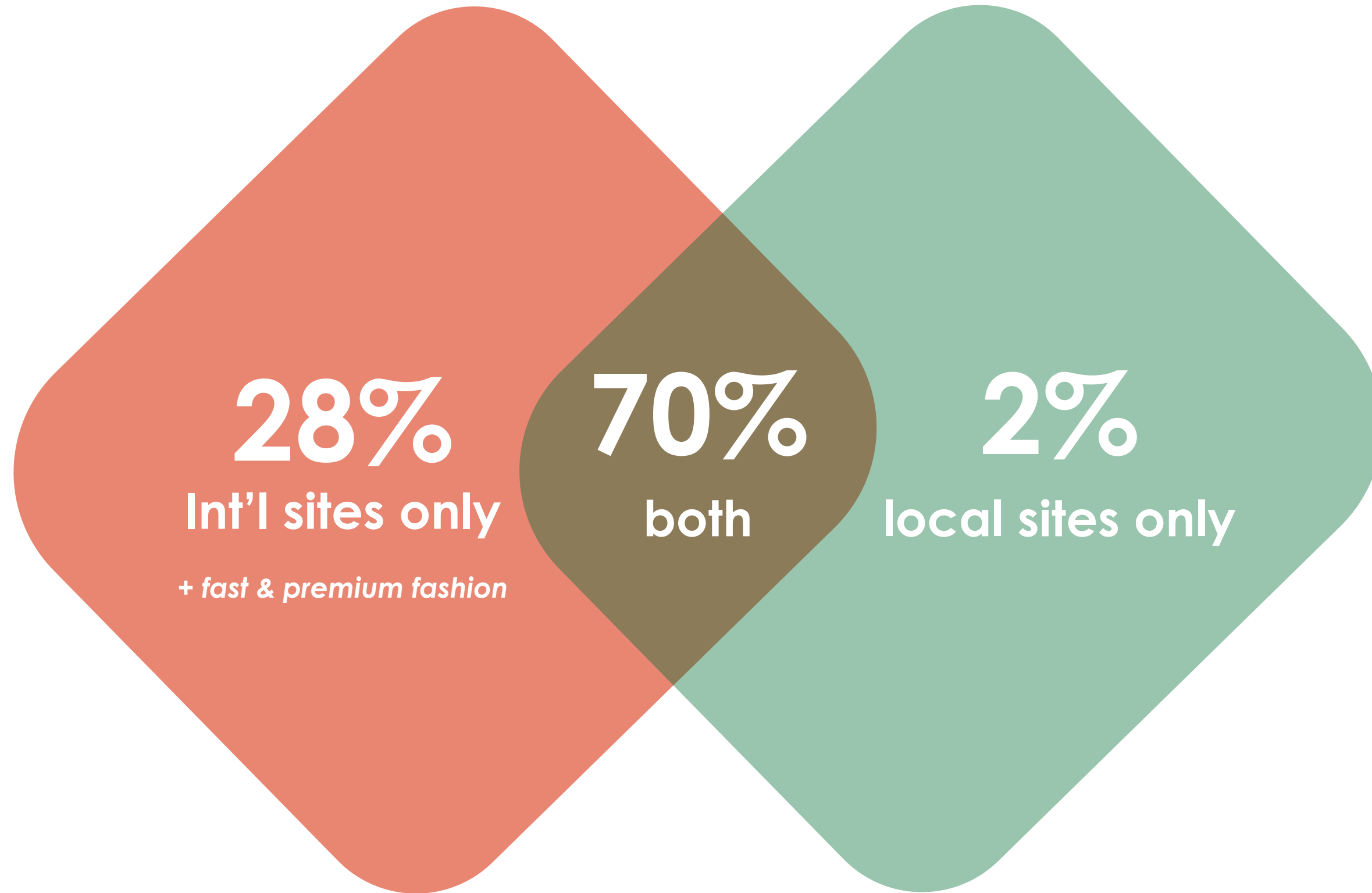
Online Deep-Dive

Online shopping is primarily about convenience



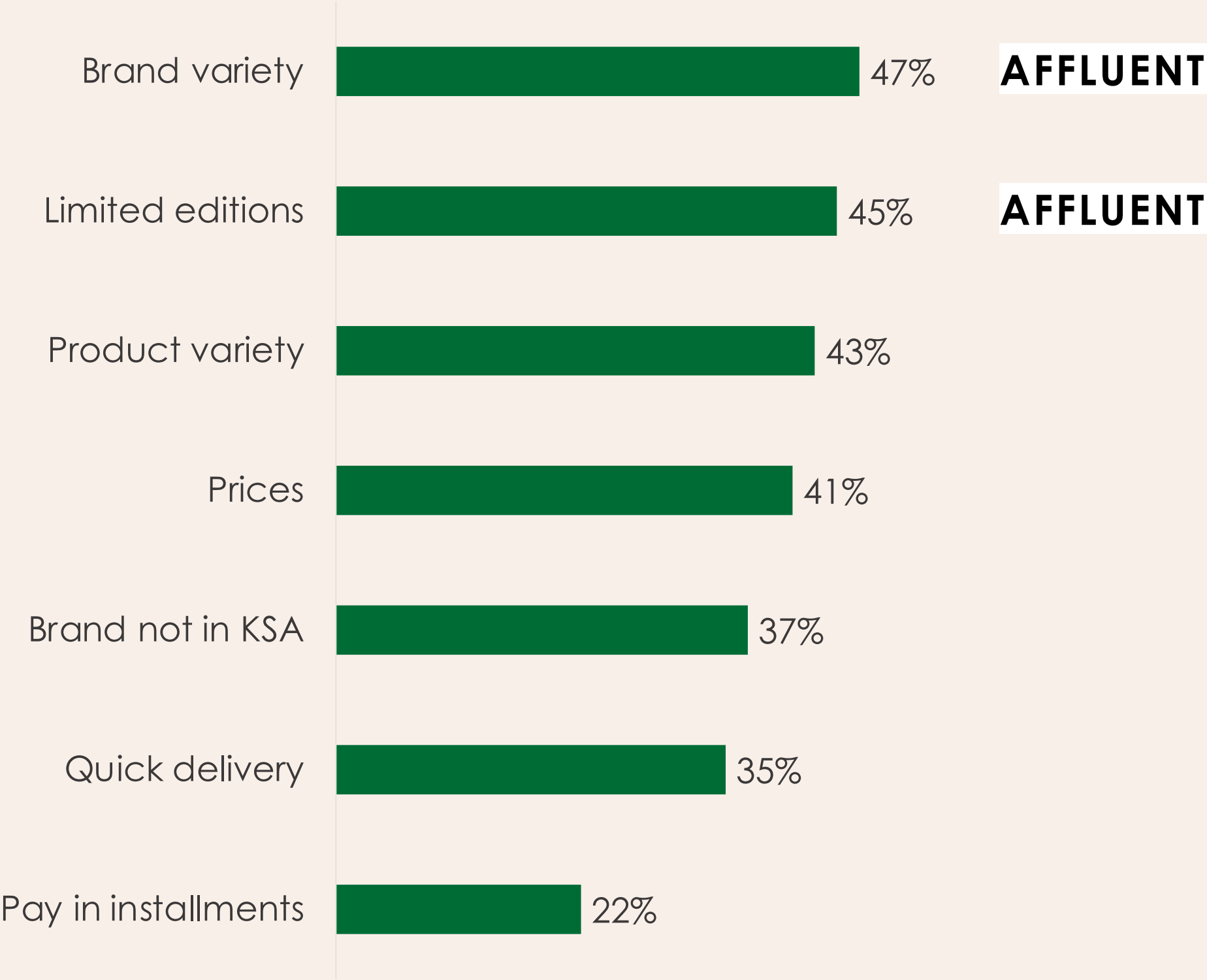
You mentioned you also shop fashion online. What are your main reasons for shopping fashion online? Please select up to three main reasons

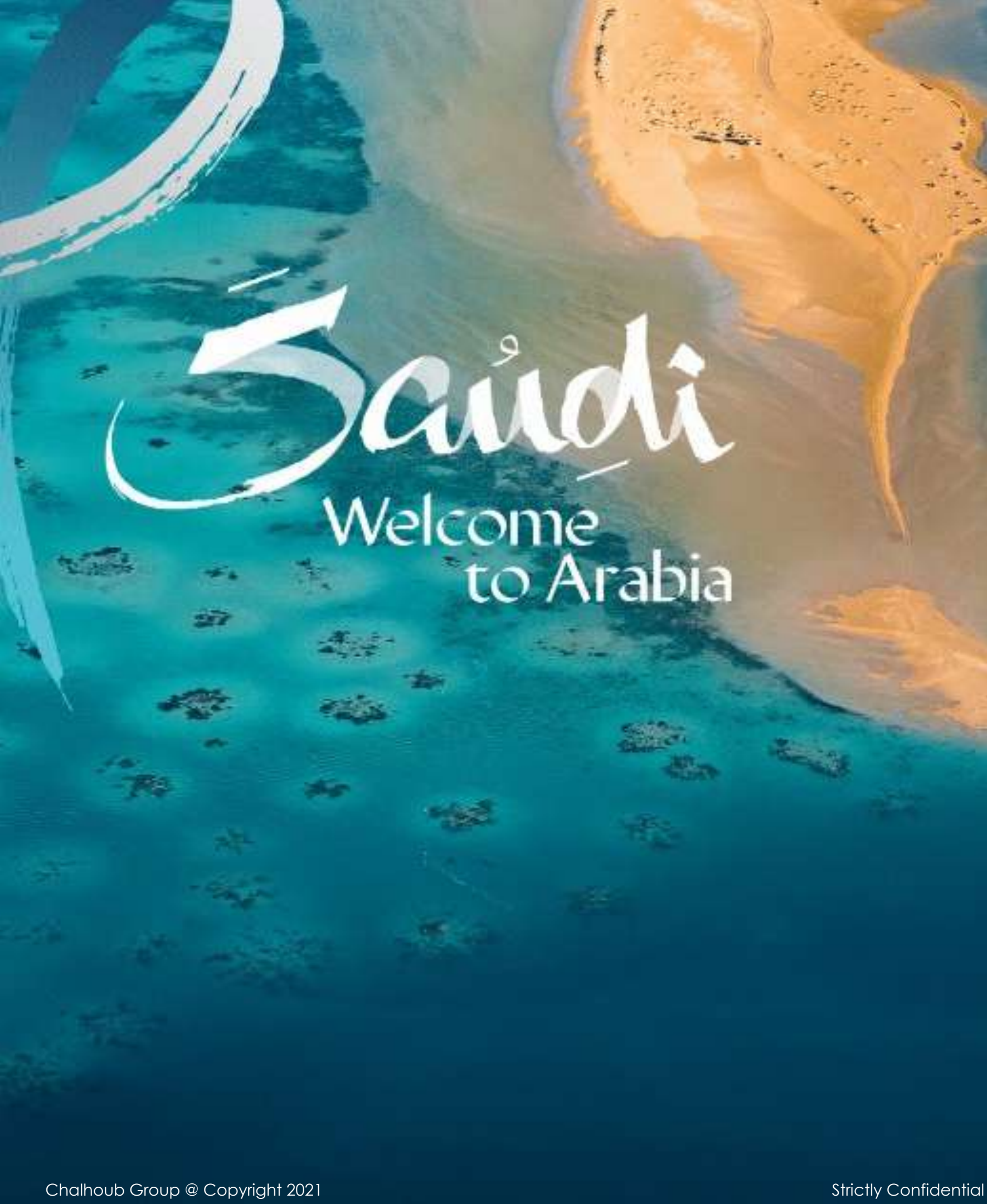
Although Saudis still turn to international sites for fashion



When shopping for fashion online, which of the below statements best describe your behaviour?

As they look for variety, limited editions and better prices

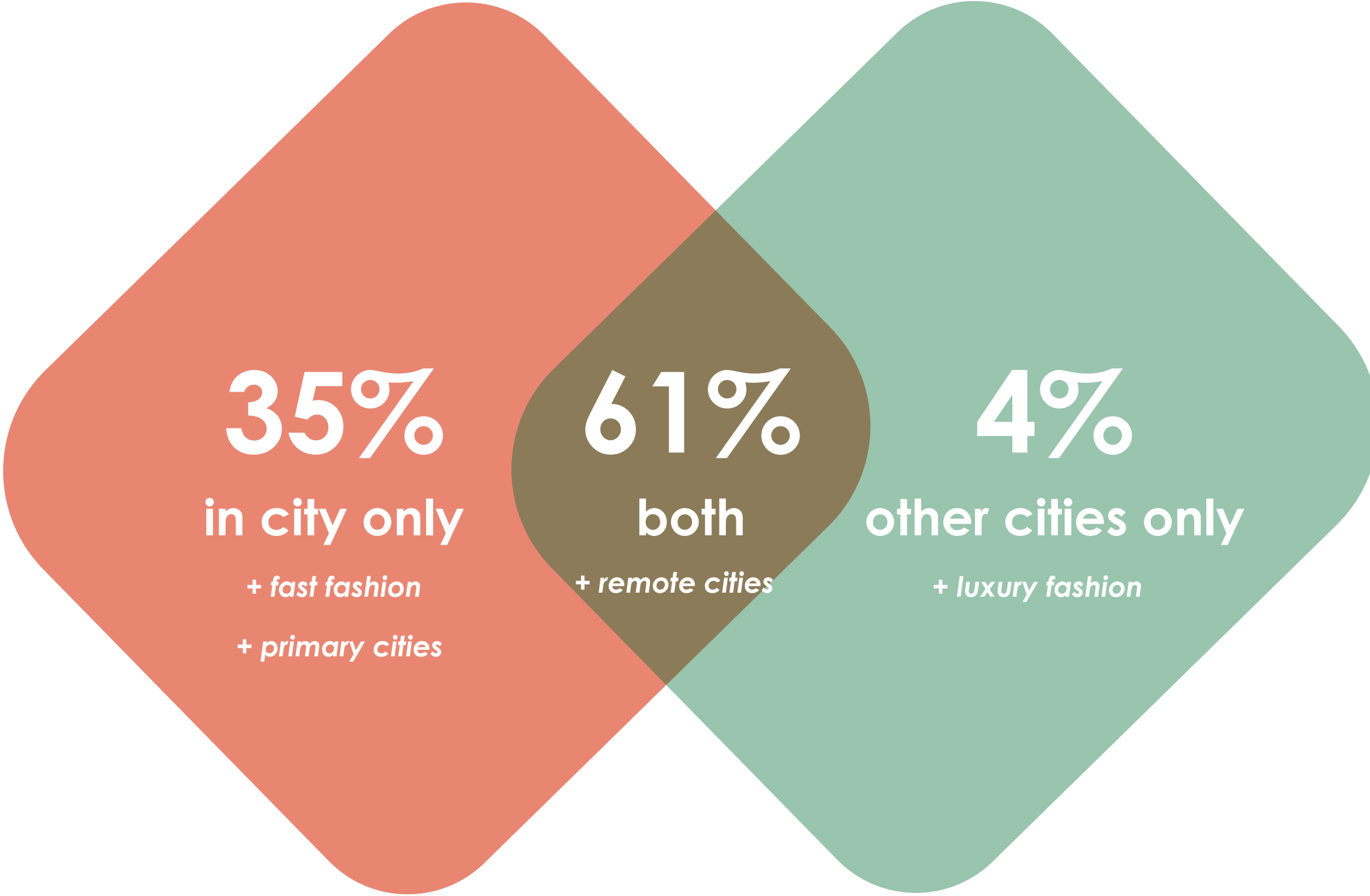




Saudi
Welcome
to Arabia

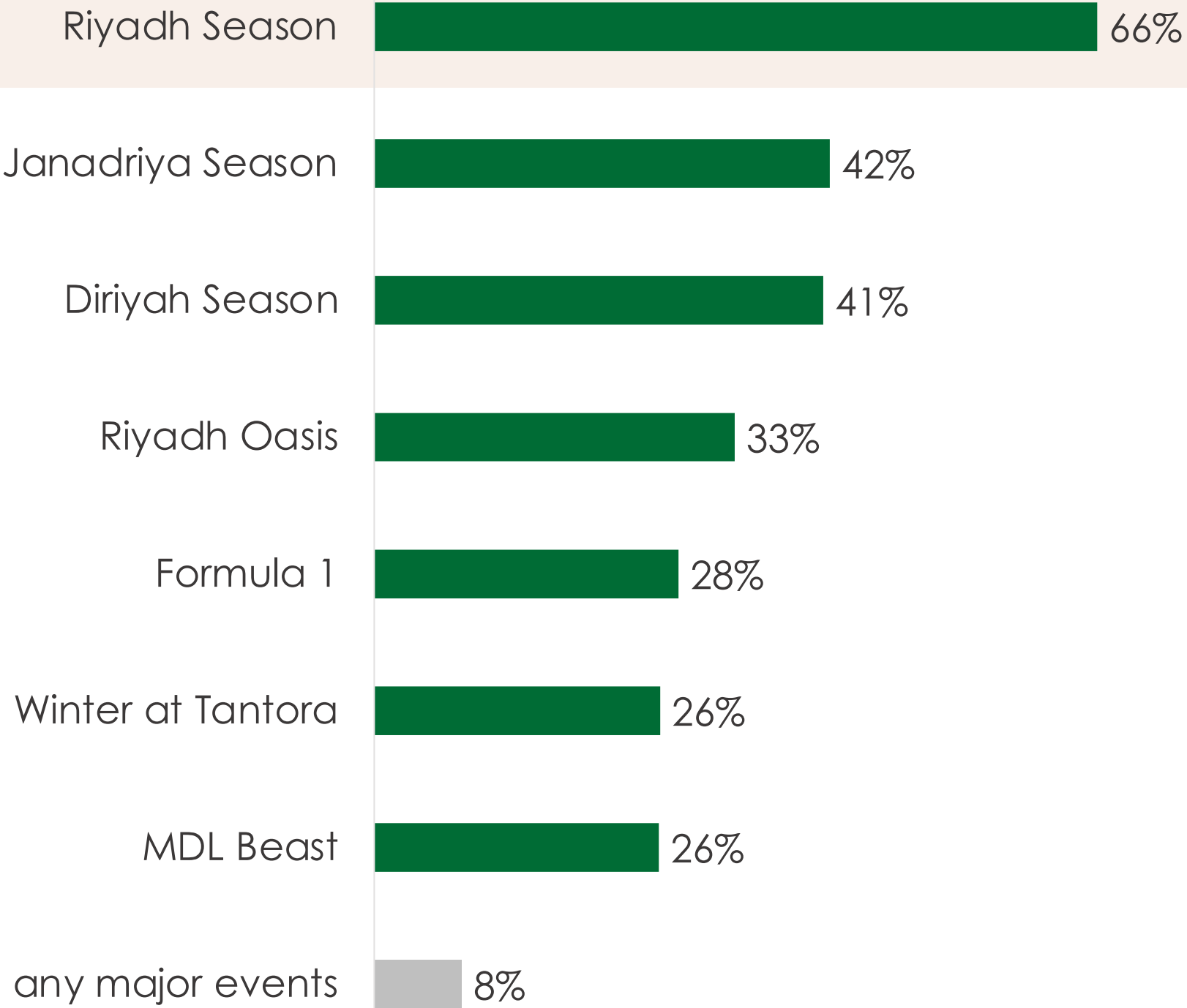
(Inter)national Travel

Domestic travel is an opportunity when it comes to developing retail in KSA



Which of the below best describes your behaviour when shopping in-store for fashion

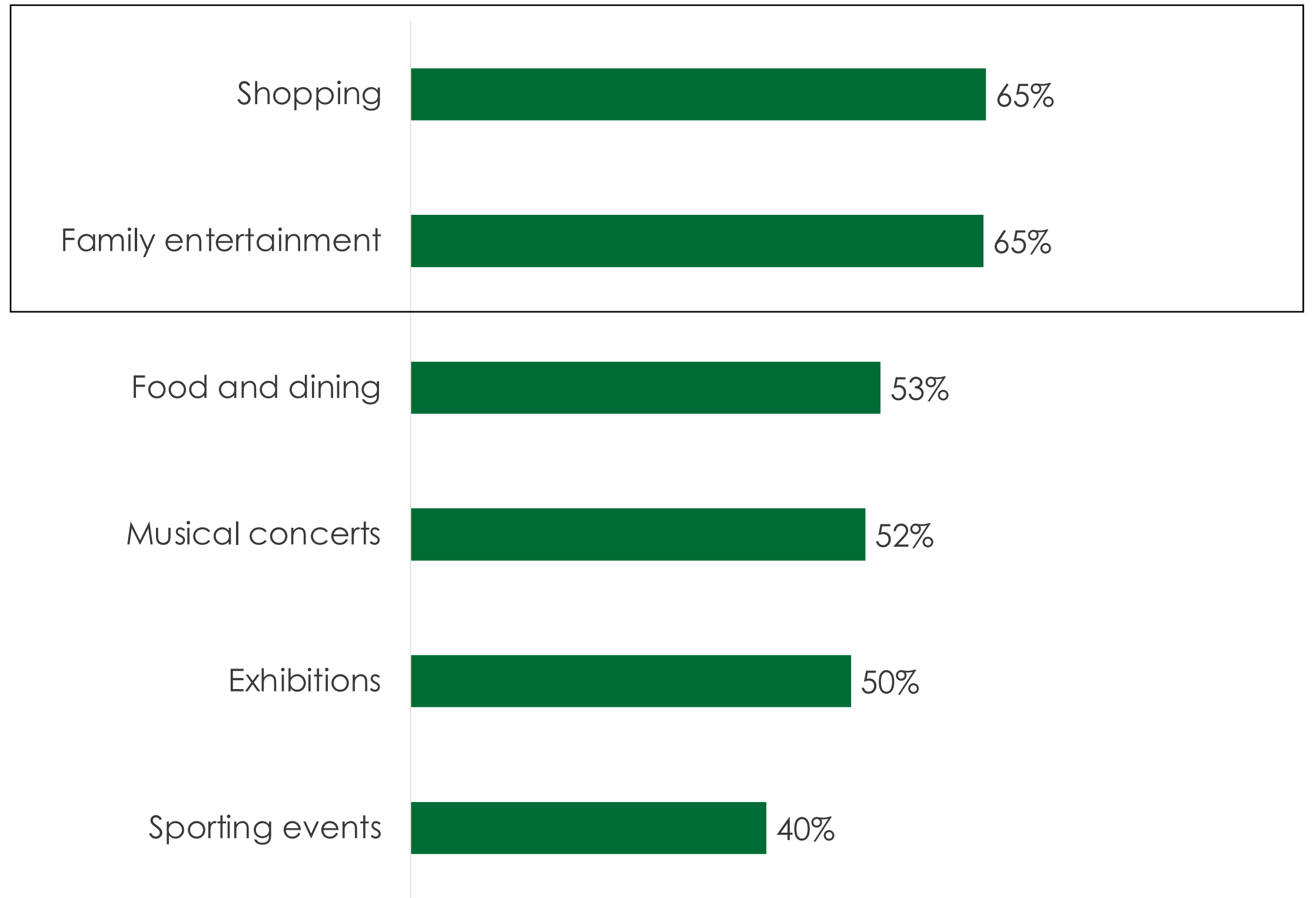
Attractiveness of seasonal pop-ups... especially Riyadh Season



Which of the below upcoming events are you most likely to attend ?



Appeal of Riyadh Season for shopping and entertainment



On shopping abroad:

“

"I prefer shopping in London, where I spend my time shopping in department stores and high streets. I like the experience of walking around, trying things on and sitting down for a coffee between"

”

Majority plan on travelling abroad, with a preference for Dubai

68%

Yes

AFFLUENT

15%

Maybe

17%

No

REMOTE CITIES

Now that the borders are opening, do you plan on travelling abroad for shopping in the next six months? **border opening pushed following the launch of fieldwork**

What would be your preferred shopping destinations abroad? Please rank up to three of your top choices



68%

Dubai PRIMARY CITIES



39%

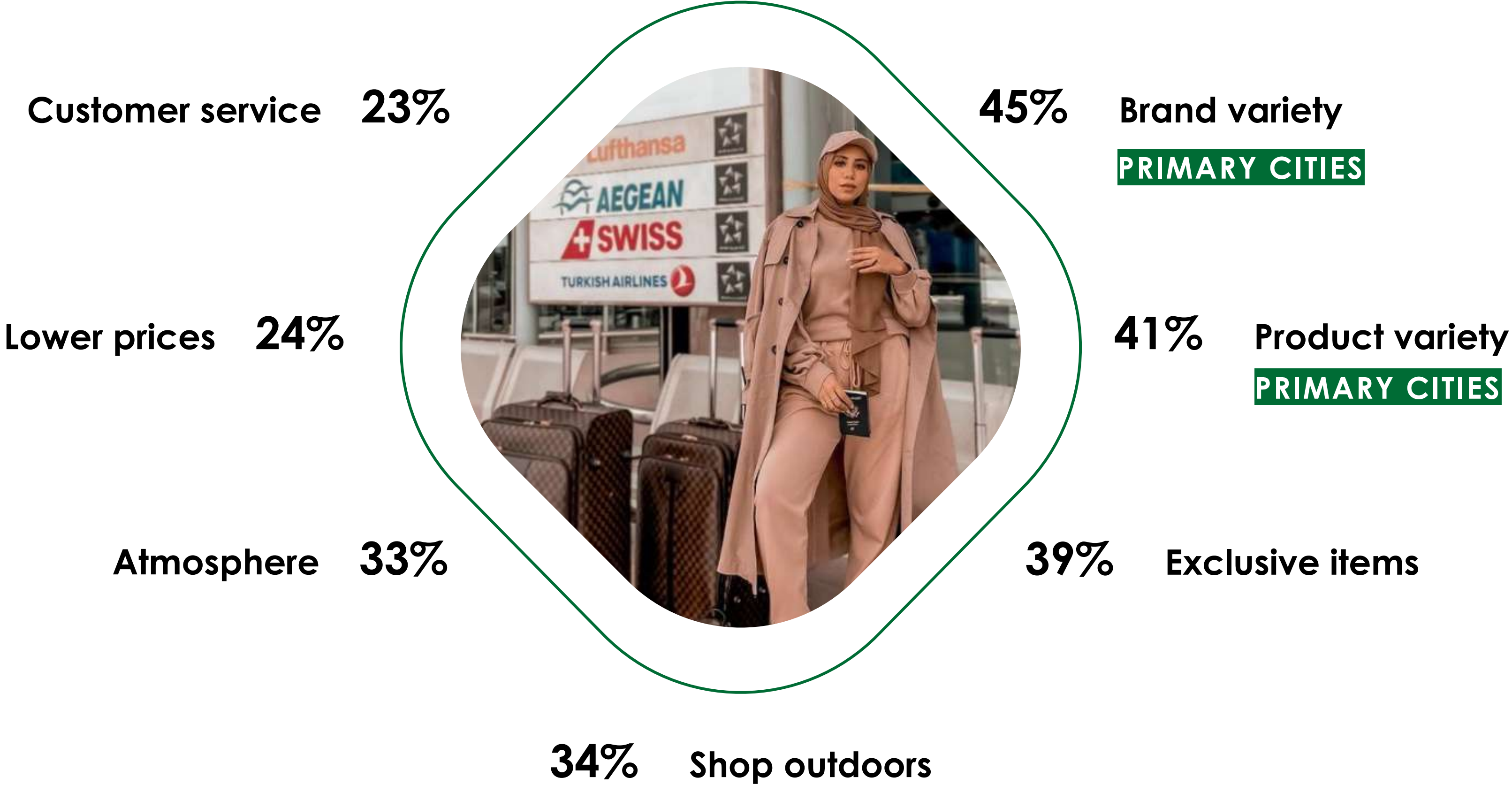
Paris



36%

London

Driven by variety and exclusivity, but also the wider shopping experience



Why do you prefer shopping abroad instead of in Saudi Arabia?



Understanding the Modern **Saudi** Fashion Consumer

Thank you